

Annalisa Ard

RPG Designer / Narrative Designer

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🌐 <https://annalisaard.portfoliobox.net/>

🏠 Oro Valley, AZ | Remote

Experience

Campaign Director & Narrative Designer

Remote / Online via Outschool.com 2020 - Present

- Design and authored over 2,000 hours of interactive narrative content with original lore, developing branching storylines, character arcs, and emotional payoffs in collaboration with teams of 4–8 players.
- Direct long-term narrative campaigns emphasizing player choice, pacing balance, and world consistency.
- Lead weekly interactive sessions requiring meticulous preparation, improvisational storytelling, and empathetic conflict resolution.
- Synthesize participant feedback into iterative narrative improvements to maintain engagement and coherence across complex storylines.

Mythology, Literature, and Language Teacher

Remote / Online via Outschool.com 2016 - Present

- Develop creative writing and worldbuilding curricula integrating mythology, narrative theory, and popular media to strengthen storytelling fundamentals.
- Guide students through advanced narrative techniques, structure, and tone for both linear and interactive storytelling.
- Deliver personalized narrative analysis and feedback fostering confidence, creative problem-solving, and communication skills.

Freelance Writer & Content Creator

Remote / multiple international locations 2012-2016

- Created engaging articles, letters, campaigns, and digital content focusing on gaming, literature, and pop culture
- Edited and optimized content for clarity, engagements, and SEO, increasing reader engagement
- Researched topics, identified and interviewed subject matter experts, and ensured factual accuracy
- Coordinated with internal and external partners to support communication strategies and project execution

Education

Master of Arts, TESOL

Virginia International University 2016

- Graduated Summa Cum Laude (4.0 GPA)
- Research: Explicit Phonetic Training to Aid Thai Native Speakers with Speaking and Listening to English
- Study Abroad: Thailand, Applied Linguistics

Bachelor of Arts, English: Creative Writing

California State University San Bernardino 2013

- Graduated Cum Laude (3.7 GPA)
- Minor: Marketing
- Study Abroad: Italy, Journalism & Media

Certifications

- Google UX Design Professional Certificate
- State of Arizona Teaching License
- Teaching Business English Certificate, TEFL Academy
- TEFL/TESOL Certification, LanguageCorps

Skills

- Narrative & quest design
- Branching dialogue systems
- Story pacing & structure
- Collaborative worldbuilding
- Cross-disciplinary communication
- Documentation & design iteration
- Agile workflow & project management
- Familiarity with Larian's design philosophy; 100% completion of Baldur's Gate 3 (all achievements unlocked)